

A net-zero Gozo by 2040?

The Nationalist Party's 2026 pledge, tested on open data and a measured forest

THE CLAIM

“A clear and realistic plan so that by 2040 Gozo becomes a Net-Zero Island.”

Partit Nazzjonalista, programme Nifs Ġdid 2026, chapter Ghawdex (our translation)

News summaries said Gozo would become net zero “through afforestation”.

Until 5 October 2026 this was part of Claim Check 011 (Labour's green-space pledge).

PLEDGE

NOT MEASURABLE

*No baseline,
no pathway.*

NOT
MEASURABLE

NOT YET
DUE

ON
TRACK

OFF
TRACK

MET

MISSED

MAIN RESULTS

118–154 kt

Gozo energy CO₂ a year

2016–20, from a 2023 study for the EU islands secretariat. No official inventory.

~157 kt

Our estimate

Gozo's population × Malta's emissions per person. Close to the study's highest year.

4.9–6.3×

Gozo's area as forest

Needed to offset those emissions by afforestation alone, at a measured semi-arid rate.

2040

A plan to make a plan

No baseline, boundary or pathway in the programme.

Cuts first

The PN's own text

Solar, EVs, buildings and restoration; afforestation is one measure, not the method.

FAIR TO SAY

Island decarbonisation is EU policy, and an energy baseline for Gozo already exists to build on. The goal is sound; the question is whether it can be measured.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ A Gozo emissions inventory and its boundary.

☐ How much from cuts, forests and offsets.

☐ The area to be afforested, and the rate assumed.

☐ Will the plan start from the 2023 baseline?